Comparing Written Numerals 1 through 10

Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1

Quick Answers

1. —	4. 8, 5	7. 4, 6, 9	10. 7, 8, —
2. —	5. 2, 7	8. 5, —	
3. —	6. —	9. 10, 7, 3	

Curriculum

Level: Kindergarten–Grade 1
K.CC.A.1–K.CC.C.7 – *problems 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10*
K.OA.A / 1.OA.C.6 – *problems 8, 10*
Difficulty 1–4 of 5 across 13 tagged checks.

1. Compare 3 and 7.
Solution: Count up: $1, 2, 3, \ldots$ — you say 3 first, then keep counting to 7. The numeral said later is greater, so 7 is greater and 3 is less. The open end of the symbol faces 7: $\boxed{3 < 7}$ "three is less than seven."

2. Compare 9 and 4.
Solution: Counting up you say 4 first and 9 later, so 9 is the greater numeral. It is written first here, so the open end of the symbol faces left, toward 9: $\boxed{9 > 4}$ "nine is greater than four."

3. Compare 6 and 6.
Solution: Both numerals name the same amount — six counters and six counters. Neither is said later when counting, so neither is greater; the correct symbol is the equal sign: $\boxed{6 = 6}$.

4. Circle the numeral that is greater: 8 or 5.
Solution: Counting up you say 5 first and 8 later, so 8 is the greater numeral — circle 8. Written greater-first, the pair is $\boxed{8 > 5}$.

5. Circle the numeral that is less: 7 or 2.
Solution: Counting up you say 2 first, so 2 is the smaller numeral — circle 2. Written smaller-first, the pair is $\boxed{2 < 7}$.

6. Compare 10 and 8.
Solution: 10 has two digits and 8 has one, but the safe check is still counting: after 8 you say 9, then 10, so 10 comes later and is greater. Do not be tricked by the small 1 at the front of 10: $\boxed{10 > 8}$.

7. Write 4, 9, 6 from least to greatest.
Solution: Find the one you say first when counting up: 4. Of the two left, 6 is said before 9. So the order is $\boxed{4,\ 6,\ 9}$.

8. Mia starts at 2 and counts on 3 more. Write Mia's numeral, then compare it with 9.
Solution: Counting on three from 2: $3, 4, 5$. Mia's numeral is $\boxed{5}$. Now compare 5 with 9: counting up you say 5 first and 9 later, so 5 is less: $\boxed{<}$ ("five is less than nine").

9. Write 10, 3, 7 from greatest to least.
Solution: Find the one you say last when counting up: 10. Of the two left, 7 is said after 3. So greatest to least is $\boxed{10,\ 7,\ 3}$.

10. Sam's numeral is 1 more than 6. Ana's numeral is 1 less than 9. Write both numerals, then compare them.
Solution: One more than 6 means count on one: Sam's numeral is $\boxed{7}$. One less than 9 means count back one: Ana's numeral is $\boxed{8}$. Finish both counts *before* comparing. Counting up you say 7 first and 8 later, so Sam's numeral is less than Ana's: $\boxed{<}$.